Performance Review Guidelines for Managers

For people managers only. These guidelines cover the 2026 annual review cycle.

Timeline

Step	Dates
Self reviews	November 1 - 15
Manager reviews	November 16 - 30
Calibration sessions	December 1 - 12
Conversations with employees	December 14 - 18

Rating scale

Rating	Meaning
5	Exceptional - far exceeds expectations
4	Exceeds expectations
3	Meets expectations
2	Partially meets expectations
1	Does not meet expectations

Calibration guidance: no more than 15% of a department should be rated 5.

Merit increase matrix

Rating	Merit increase
5	6% - 8%
4	4% - 5%
3	2% - 3%
2	0% - 1%
1	0% and a performance improvement plan